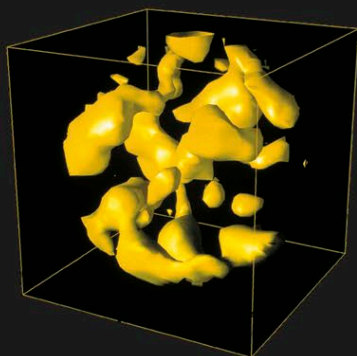


The limits of time and space

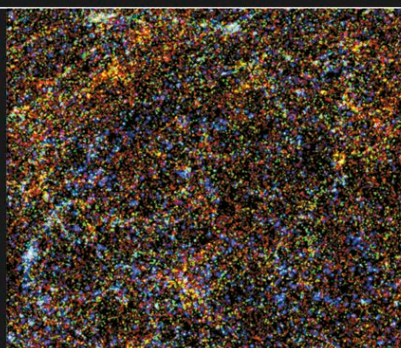


GALAXY SUPERCLUSTERS

This image, generated by plotting the positions of 15,000 galaxies, depicts the main “topographic” features of our cosmic environment out to 700 million light-years from Earth. The yellow blobs are superclusters of galaxies, which are interspersed with black voids.

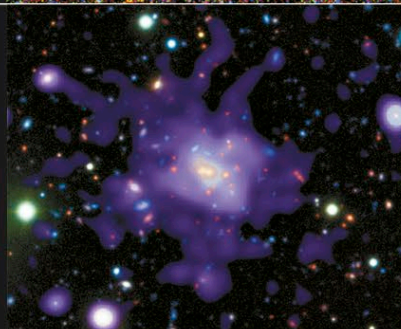
LARGE-SCALE STRUCTURES

This view of the sky, in infrared light, shows how galaxies outside the Milky Way are distributed in clusters and filamentary structures. The galaxies are color-coded according to brightness, with bright ones in blue and faint ones in red.



DISTANT CLUSTER OF GALAXIES

This massive cluster of galaxies is one of the most distant known to astronomers, some 8.5 billion light-years from Earth. Superimposed on the optical picture is an X-ray image revealing hot gas (shown in purple) that pervades the cluster.



DWARF GALAXIES BURSTING INTO LIFE

9 billion light-years from Earth

Tiny young galaxies brimming with stars in the process of formation, some 9 billion light-years away, are seen in this image taken at near-infrared wavelengths by the Hubble Space Telescope. They stand out in the image because energy from the new stars has caused oxygen in the gas around them to light up like a neon sign. This phase of rapid star birth is thought to represent an important stage in the formation of dwarf galaxies, the most numerous type of galaxy in the universe.

